

Skills

Transferring From a Bed to a Wheelchair Using a Transfer Belt

Checklist

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S = Satisfactory U = Unsatisfactory NP = Not Performed

Step	S	U	NP	Comments
Verified the health care provider's orders.	☐	☐	☐	
Gathered the necessary equipment and supplies.	☐	☐	☐	
Provided for the patient's privacy.	☐	☐	☐	
Introduced self to the patient and family.	☐	☐	☐	
Identified the patient using two identifiers. Compared these identifiers with the information on the patient's identification bracelet.	☐	☐	☐	
Explained the procedure to the patient and ensured that the patient agreed to treatment.	☐	☐	☐	
Performed hand hygiene and applied gloves if indicated. Donned appropriate personal protective equipment (PPE) based on the patient's need for isolation precautions or risk of exposure to bodily fluids.	☐	☐	☐	
Locked the bed brakes and wheelchair wheels. Secured the wheelchair wheels.	☐	☐	☐	
Adjusted the height of the bed to the level of the wheelchair seat.	☐	☐	☐	
Placed and positioned the wheelchair.	☐	☐	☐	
Secured the wheels.	☐	☐	☐	
Raised the footrests and swung the leg rests outward on the wheelchair.	☐	☐	☐	
Sat the patient up on the side of the bed:	☐	☐	☐	

1. With the patient supine, raised the head of the bed 30 degrees.
2. Turned the patient onto his or her side facing the nurse.
3. Stood opposite the patient's hips. Turned diagonally.
4. Created a wide base of support.
5. Slipped arm under the patient's shoulders, supporting the head and the neck.
6. Placed other arm over the patient's thighs.
7. Moved the patient's lower legs and feet over the side of the bed, allowing the patient's upper legs to swing down.
8. At the same time, shifted weight to back leg and lifted the patient on the side of the bed.

Helped the patient move to the edge of the mattress.

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Allowed the patient to sit on the side of the bed for a few minutes before transferring him/her to a wheelchair. Asked if the patient felt dizzy.

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Helped the patient apply stable, nonskid shoes. Placed the patient's weight-bearing leg forward, with the weaker foot to the back.

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Placed the transfer belt on the waist of the patient.

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Slid the metal trimmed end of the gait belt through the teeth on the other end. Pulled the metal trimmed end away from the teeth. Tightened the belt until snug on the patient's center of gravity.

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Spread feet. Flexed hips and knees, and aligned knees with those of the patient.

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Grasped the transfer belt along the patient's sides.

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Positioned self slightly in front of the patient.

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On the count of three, rocked the patient up to a standing position.

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While rocking the patient in a back-and-forth motion, made sure body weight was moving in the same direction as the patient's body weight. Asked the patient to push up off the mattress.

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Maintained the stability of the patient's weak or paralyzed leg with knee.

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Instructed the patient to feel for the edge of the wheelchair seat against the legs and to use the armrests for support.

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Flexed hips and knees while lowering the patient into the wheelchair.

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Ensured the patient was positioned well back in the seat. Provided support to the extremities if needed. Ensured proper alignment in a sitting position.

Lowered the footrests after transferring the patient, and placed the patient's feet on them.

Provided comfort measures for the patient and ensured that the call light was within reach.

Placed a blanket over the patient's legs, if needed.

Monitored the patient's vital signs as needed. Asked if the patient felt dizzy or fatigued. Noted the patient's behavior during the transfer. Remained in front of the patient until he or she regains balance. Continued to provide physical support to a weak or cognitively impaired patient.

Documented how long the patient was in the chair and the care provided in the EMR.

Learner: _____
Evaluator: _____
Date: _____

Signature: _____
Signature: _____